ever there is a political slump in the country.

With regard to the elections to the Indian Legislative Assembly the latest report (dated November 24th, 1934) goes to show that the official Congress Party has captured 43 seats, the Congress Nationalist Party 8 seats and others approximately 46. Among the 46 non-descripts, at least 10 are expected to be close upon sixty in a house of approximately 145 members.

The Report of the Joint Parliamentary Committee on Indian Constitutional Reforms contains no surprise for one who is familiar with the contents of the White Paper. The Report is approved by a large majority of 31 members of the Committee. The labour members of the Committee have submitted an alternative scheme which is much more liberal than the majority report. On the other hand, Lord Salisbury and four other members have submitted, and the report concedes only provincial autonomy and opposes responsible Government at the centre. The majority report has whittled down still further the already inadequate proposals of the White Paper with a view to placating the Diehard opposition in Parliament. In view of the whittling down, it is widely believed that when the Government of India Bill is introduced on the basis of the report of the Joint Committee, it will have the support of an overwhelming majority in the House of Commons.

The following are some of the important points on which the Joint Committee modify the White Paper proposals :

1. Additional provisions are recommended in relation to 'Law and Order' as follows :

   (*i*) The consent of the Governor, given in his discretion, should be required to any legislation affecting Police Acts and to any rules made thereunder affecting the organisation or discipline of the Police.

   (*ii*) Records of the Intelligence Department relating to terrorism should not be disclosed outside the Police force except to such public officers as the Governor may direct.

   (*iii*) For the purpose of combating terrorism, the Governor should have the power to take under his own control any branch of Government which it is necessary to use for that purpose.